

The interview with the client, Maria Musialik, on the 21st of November 2022

Bartosz Bielawski: *Good morning, Ms. Maria.*

Maria Musialik: *Good morning.*

BB: *Last time you contacted me with the request to help you with your planning problem, is that correct?*

MM: *Yes, it is. I have heard from your grandma that you could help me.*

BB: *Indeed. Could you describe what is the problem?*

MM: *Surely. So I have used a paper planner since I remember. In the past, the world wasn't as digitally oriented as it is today, and people relied on the simplicity of pen and paper for their planning needs. They used to do all the things in such a way. Many of my acquaintances still adhere to this method for organizing their schedules and daily tasks. I am used to it as well but I am no longer satisfied with that! I am fed up with having to carry my notebook and a pen everywhere I go or with writing the same tasks again and again each day. What is more, I am not an artist and my written tasks are just sentences - without any colours, highlights, or details. I am a forward-looking person and I just need a change. I will be truly thankful if you could help me.*

BB: *Of course, I will help you. That is why I am here. If I may ask, do you have a smartphone?*

MM: *Yes, I do.*

BB: *And do you carry it with you when you leave your house?*

MM: *Yes, I do. Why are you asking?*

BB: *I thought that maybe you could download one of the to-do apps that might help you with planning. It will definitely overcome the limitations you are facing right now.*

MM: *It might be surprising but I have already tried a few such apps. However, they have not matched up to my expectations. They were either too complicated to manage or I could not use them without access to the internet. Most of them looked like sticky notes – all my tasks were in one place and the only thing that I was able to do was to create and delete a task. They had categories and even an aesthetic design but they did not work how I expected.*

BB: *Alright, I understand. What if I created a special application for you based on your needs?*

MM: *That would be really remarkable. Are you able to do that?*

BB: *Yes, I am. I have an experience in programming and it will not be a problem. But I have to ask first what is the operating system on your smartphone?*

MM: *I have the Samsung so possibly it is Android, isn't it?*

BB: *Yes, it is. Do you have any requirements for how the app should work and look?*

MM: *I have never thought about it and I was not prepared for speaking about the activity and the design of my app. I know too little about apps to describe them for you.*

BB: *You do not have to worry about it although I know you feel confident when you have everything planned. What if you described to me how your existing planner “works”? Based on that, I could recreate your planner in digital form as an app.*

MM: *Actually, it worked really simply. Firstly, there were categories based on my activities, for instance: shopping, work, church, and family. Under the name of each category, there was a table with 4 columns named consecutively: a name, a start date, a deadline, and a description. That was where I put my tasks down. Then, every day I analyzed which tasks were “assigned to” the present day or week. I must admit that it was horribly tiring and I was afraid that I would overlook a task. Not to mention that although I might have finished a task, it was still taking up its space making a mess.*

BB: *I understand. Do you have any expectations of how your planner would work more efficiently? What, if possible, could be done automatically?*

MM: *I think it would be much easier if all tasks had a filter option, or even better if I could get an already prepared plan at the beginning of the day. I really would like to know what tasks I will have on a chosen day and generally during the week. Moreover, it would be great if I did not have to rewrite the tasks each day, that I could choose one task will be assigned to only one day, for instance: visiting someone; the second one would be repeated every specific day, for example: going to the church and the last one, which I could not find in any to-do app so far, would be repeated until I did it. Additionally, it would be perfect if my planner could remind me that the deadline for a task is coming or I have some overdue tasks.*

BB: *Alright, thank you for your detailed description. I noted everything down and I will base the app on that.*

MM: *Thank you so much. I cannot believe that the solution might be so simple. I am looking forward to seeing the app.*

BB: *The app will be done soon. Would you like to add something more?*

MM: *No, I wouldn't. I think I said everything I wanted.*

BB: *Good. Thank you for the meeting, Ms. Maria.*

MM: *I also thank you so much.*